

of any individual to color their decisions, even when they're acting in good faith.

- **Credentials:** Academic credentials tend to represent a significant commitment of time towards gaining mastery of a subject, and therefore requiring a particular degree may increase the likelihood of accurate information. However, not all groups are equally represented in higher education. Degree completion is uneven across race and income factors (among others), making academia not demographically representative of our society as a whole. Some perspectives are therefore systematically underrepresented in groups with advanced degrees.
- **Peer Review:** Peer review sometimes only results in collaborative improvements to a work. It can also prevent the publication of very obviously flawed or poorly executed or analyzed research. Very new or radical ideas may be initially rejected because they are such a departure from existing dogma. Peer review is largely a practice of academia, therefore has the same exclusionary problems mentioned in the credentials section. It is possible for individual reviewers to act in a biased or unethical way to prevent the publication of some works.
- **Fact Checking:** Not a lot of downside here. Let me know if your students come up with anything good.
- **Domains:** For some top level domains (mostly just .gov and .edu) looking at the domain provides some assurance that the web content there is an official communication of a particular institution. There really isn't any problem with domains excluding